made sense in the short term but worried that in time, the groups that were neutral now may just become a new threat. Baitullah Mehsud, he pointed out, was once an ally of the Pakistani military (*Daily Times*, 2009).

The strategic difference between Operation 'Rah-e-Rast' and Operation 'Rah-e-Nijat' was that while 20,000 troops were used in Swat operation, more reliance was on air power to destroy the TTP hideouts in the mountainous region of Waziristan (*Daily Times*, 2009).

Analysts did not consider it an appropriate approach to annihilate the hardened militants who were fighting a guerrilla war in harsh terrains (*Daily Times*, 2009). The result was that the operation against the TTP in South Waziristan could not be concluded. Moreover, the Swati TTP kept threatening from across the border.

IS A MILITARY METHOD THE RIGHT SOLUTION?

Military operations should be the last resort to tackle an insurgency. Ikram Sehgal, defence and political analyst, said:

> The army increasingly has had to deal with internal strife instead of securing the borders. Other than drawing crucial reserves away from countering the aggressive defence postures of the Indians, they are compelled to devote time and effort to burgeoning internal problems of different dimensions. Fighting against one's own population can put stress on any army in the world, raising adverse perceptions among the populace, extremely dangerous for a country that thrives on glorifying its armed forces (Sehgal, 2011).

Ideally, instead of armed forces, paramilitary forces or a special counter-insurgency force should have been used for this purpose. The army could then have supported as the occasional back-up force for swift and short-lived operations. When the Pakistan Army had achieved initial success against dismantling the command and control structure of the militants, especially in Swat, the emphasis should have been on intelligence-based dedicated operations to pursue the higher echelon as well as disperse command structure and most importantly their sources of funding. When the army started its operation against the militants in FATA in 2002, there were fears of mutiny and disobedience.